

Executive Report

Monthly Revenue Growth & Performance Intelligence | Oct 2016 - Aug 2018

Period: October 2016 - August 2018 (23 months) **Prepared from:**

data/processed/monthly_revenue_processed.csv

1. Executive Summary

Revenue grew from 43,000 (Oct-2016) to a period peak of 1,061,000 (May-2018), a total of 15,737,501 recognized across the full period. The business shows a launch-growth phase through late 2017 followed by a stable plateau in 2018. There is no evidence of a sustained multi-month decline anywhere in the series, including in the most recent month on record.

2. Business Context

The originating business problem: revenue data existed but there was no centralized, reliable monthly performance layer to answer basic growth questions on demand (see project brief). This report and its supporting SQL/Python/dashboard pipeline directly answer the business questions that the available data supports.

3. Performance Overview

Metric	Value
Total revenue (full period)	15,737,501
Number of months	23
Highest revenue month	May-2018 (1,061,000)
Lowest revenue month	Oct-2016 (43,000, first month)
Best MoM growth	Nov-2016, +144.19% (low-base effect — see Limitations)
Worst MoM growth	Dec-2017, -24.05% (post-spike reversion)

4. Revenue Growth

Revenue rose steeply from Oct-2016 through a peak of 1,027,013 in Nov-2017, then plateaued in a ~860,000-1,061,000 band through Aug-2018. The 3-month rolling average confirms this: it climbs continuously through 2017 and then flattens from roughly Apr-2018 onward.

5. MoM Performance

Full month-by-month MoM growth is in data/processed/monthly_revenue_processed.csv. Two periods deserve separate framing rather than being averaged into a single "typical MoM growth" figure:

- **Oct-Dec 2016:** extreme MoM % (+144.19%, +140.95%) driven by a near-zero starting base, not a repeatable rate.

- **Nov-Dec 2017:** a sharp spike (+61.73%) immediately followed by the steepest decline in the series (-24.05%) — consistent with a one-off event and its reversion rather than a structural shift (the data cannot identify the event).

Outside these two windows, MoM growth ranges from -15.33% to +54.15%. Most months fall within $\pm 20\%$; the exceptions are Jan-2017 (+54.15%), Mar-2017 (+47.79%), and Jan-2018 (+22.05%).

6. Order & AOV Dynamics

Not available. The source data provided for this engagement contains only monthly revenue totals — no order count, order ID, or customer data exists anywhere in the provided files. Order volume, order growth %, and Average Order Value could not be computed and are not included in this report. See Limitations (Section 11) and docs/assumptions.md for the full explanation.

7. Recent Performance

The last 3 months on record (Jun-Aug 2018) averaged 1,022,829/month vs. 1,039,333/month for the prior 3 months (Mar-May 2018) — a **-1.59%** change. The change is small relative to the month-to-month swings in the series (rolling 3-month std dev ranged 14,295-126,640 across 2018) and does not, on its own, indicate a trend reversal.

8. Key Signals

- No consecutive multi-month revenue decline exists anywhere in the 23-month series (longest streak: 1 month).
- The Aug-2018 dip (-4.00%) follows a positive July (+0.53%) and is best read as an isolated month, not the start of a decline.
- Only 11 of 23 months support a Year-over-Year comparison; treat early YoY figures (Oct-Dec 2017) with caution, as they are measured against a low prior-year base.

9. Business Recommendations

See analysis/business_recommendations.md for the full list, tied explicitly to the findings above. Highlights:

1. Report growth with a rolling average + decline-streak view, not a single MoM % in isolation.
2. Investigate the Nov-2017 spike to determine if it is repeatable.
3. Set consecutive_decline_months ≥ 2 as the management-review trigger.
4. Close the order-level data gap — this is the single highest-value next step, since it unlocks the volume-vs-value diagnostic the business originally asked for.
5. Reconcile total revenue against a second source (ledger/payment processor) before using this pipeline for finance-facing reporting.

10. Methodology

See `analysis/methodology.md` for the full approach: validate before calculating, define every metric once, reconcile SQL against Python independently, and document gaps rather than filling them.

11. Limitations

- **No order-level data.** Order count, order growth %, and AOV are out of scope for this engagement — the source data does not support them (see `docs/assumptions.md`).
- **No causal data.** There is no marketing spend, promotional calendar, seasonality flag, or external event data. All findings describe **what** happened to revenue, never **why**, unless independently confirmed (nothing was, in this engagement).
- **Limited YoY coverage.** Only 11 of 23 months have a valid Year-over-Year figure.
- **Unreconciled against a second source.** Revenue totals have not been checked against a general ledger or payment processor export.
- **Currency unspecified** in the source data.